

only the skin. So we healed most of the face using the Spot Healing tool, and did our touch-ups using the Healing tool. We also used the Clone Stamp tool in very few areas, because we wanted to flatten the skin texture, and also because both the Healing and Spot Healing tools were not giving us the desired results.

Once we were done, we set the Opacity and the Fill to 85 per cent each so as to get some of the original texture and lines back from the background image, and then flattened the image. You can see the results below:

We now come to the Patch tool, which is very useful for some specific purposes. A lot of us have digital cameras, and we've all started clicking a lot of photographs. In fact, with the coming of megapixel camera phones, there's millions of budding photographers out there. However, the one thing most of us forget to do is to turn off the date stamp in the photographs. As a result, we get this irritating little orange-coloured date and time stamp at the bottom right of the image. In order to remove this, you can use the Clone Stamp tool or even just cut a patch and paste it over the date, but the easiest way to do this is by using the Patch tool.

You can just select a patch, then drag it and drop it on the area you want to hide. Instead of just pasting the patch, like a copy-



Here's the final result when we brought back some of the textures and lines from the original image by decreasing the Opacity and Fill



Here's the final result from using only the Clone Stamp tool, so that you can compare the beauty of using only the Clone Stamp tool as compared to using all the retouching tools in unison